

Silent Night, Holy Night

Text: Joseph Mohr, 1818;
tr. John Freeman Young, 1863
STILLE NACHT irregular

Music: Franz Gruber, 1818

The musical score is written for guitar and four-part vocal harmony. It consists of three systems of music. Each system includes a guitar chord diagram at the beginning of a line, followed by a musical staff with a treble clef and a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The time signature is 6/8. The lyrics are written below the staff, with each line of music corresponding to a line of lyrics. The lyrics are in English and German. The first system of music is for the first line of the hymn, the second system is for the second line, and the third system is for the third line. The guitar chords are indicated by letters (Bb, F, Bb, Eb, Bb, F, Bb) and diagrams showing the fretting of the strings. The vocal parts are represented by four staves, each with a different part of the harmony. The lyrics are written below the staves, with each line of music corresponding to a line of lyrics. The lyrics are in English and German. The first system of music is for the first line of the hymn, the second system is for the second line, and the third system is for the third line.

System 1:

Chords: B $\flat$, F, B $\flat$

Lyrics: 1 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! All is calm, all is bright,
2 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Shep - herds quake at the sight,
3 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Son of God, love's pure light,
4 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Won - drous star, lend thy light,

System 2:

Chords: E $\flat$, B $\flat$, E $\flat$, B $\flat$

Lyrics: round yon vir - gin moth - er and child, ho - ly In - fant, so ten - der and mild,
glo - ries stream from heav - en a - far, heav'n - ly hosts sing: "Al - le - lu - ia,
ra - diant beams from Thy ho - ly face, with the dawn of re - deem - ing grace,
with the an - gels let us sing, Al - le - lu - ia to our King,

System 3:

Chords: F, B $\flat$, F, B $\flat$

Lyrics: sleep in heav - en - ly peace, sleep in heav - en - ly peace.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born."
Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born.